Amerimed
WELLNESS INSTITUTE

Amerimed Wellness Institute
2800 Pacific Crest Boulevard, San Jose, CA 95134
www.amerimedwellness.example

HUMAN RESOURCES · AMW-HR-001

Workforce Handbook & Code of Conduct

Employment practices, professional standards and workplace safety for the Amerimed workforce

Document ID	AMW-HR-001	**Version**	6.0
Effective date	2026-01-01	**Next review**	2027-01-01
Policy owner	Rosa Delgado, Chief People Officer	**Approved by**	Dr. Jonathan Reyes-Whitaker, President & CEO
Applies to	Employees, medical staff, residents, students, volunteers and contracted staff ("workforce members")	**Classification**	Internal

1. Our mission and standards

Mission: to deliver whole-person care, close to home, for every community we serve on the West Coast. **Standards of behaviour - "CARE": C**ompassion, **A**ccountability, **R**espect, **E**xcellence.

2. Pre-employment requirements

Requirement	Applies to
Background check (criminal, sex-offender registry, OIG/SAM exclusion lists)	All workforce members
Licence / certification primary-source verification	Licensed clinicians (RN, MD, PA, RT, pharmacist, etc.)
Health screening: TB test, immunity to MMR, varicella, hepatitis B; Tdap	All patient-facing roles
Annual influenza vaccination (or declination + masking during flu season)	All workforce members on campus
Drug screening (10-panel)	All new hires
Fingerprinting (Live Scan / state DOJ)	Behavioral health, pediatrics and pharmacy staff, as required by state law

Monthly checks against the **OIG List of Excluded Individuals/Entities (LEIE)**, **SAM.gov** and state Medicaid exclusion lists continue throughout employment. An excluded individual cannot work on any federally funded

service.

3. Hours, overtime and meal breaks

- **California** non-exempt staff: daily overtime after 8 hours, double time after 12 hours; a 30-minute meal period before the 5th hour; 10-minute rest breaks per 4 hours worked. Alternative 12-hour shift schedules are adopted by secret-ballot election under the IWC Wage Order 5 rules.
- **Oregon and Washington:** state meal/rest rules apply. **Washington** limits mandatory overtime for nurses (RCW 49.28.140). **Oregon** limits nurse shifts under the hospital nurse staffing law (ORS 441.166).
- **Nurse staffing:** California hospitals follow the statutory nurse-to-patient ratios (e.g. 1:2 ICU, 1:4 ED, 1:5 Med-Surg).
- **Minimum wage:** all Amerimed workforce members in California earn at least the healthcare minimum wage required under SB 525 (as phased in), or the local minimum, whichever is higher.

4. Benefits and leave

- Medical, dental and vision plans (Amerimed Health Plan, 90% employer-paid for employee-only cover)
- 403(b) retirement plan with a 6% match
- **Paid time off:** 22 days (years 1-3), 27 days (years 4-9), 32 days (10+), inclusive of sick time. At least the state paid sick leave minimum is protected (CA: 40 hours / 5 days; OR: 40 hours; WA: 1 hour per 40 worked).
- **Family leave:** coordinated with FMLA, CFRA (CA), OFLA and Paid Leave Oregon, and WA Paid Family & Medical Leave
- Tuition reimbursement up to USD 6,000 per year; nurse residency and specialty fellowships
- Employee Assistance Program, peer-support "Code Lavender" team and free counselling for all staff

5. Professional conduct

5.1 Patient privacy (HIPAA)

- Access patient information **only** when you need it for your job ("minimum necessary").
- Every access to the electronic health record (EHR) is logged and audited. Looking up your own record, a family member's, a co-worker's or a celebrity's without a work reason is a violation. It can lead to termination and to fines under HIPAA and California law (Civil Code 56; Health & Safety Code 1280.15).
- Never post patient photos, stories or identifiable details on social media.

5.2 Professional boundaries

Workforce members must not have romantic or financial relationships with patients they care for, accept gifts above USD 25 from patients, or give personal medical advice outside their role.

5.3 Vendor interactions

Vendor representatives must register through the vendor credentialing system. Meals and gifts from pharmaceutical and device companies are prohibited. Payments to physicians are reported under the **Open Payments (Sunshine Act)** programme.

5.4 Impairment

Working while impaired by alcohol, cannabis (legal under state law but prohibited at work) or other drugs is prohibited. Reasonable-suspicion testing applies. Self-referral to the Employee Assistance Program or a professional health programme is encouraged and supported.

6. Workplace safety

- **Workplace violence prevention:** California Labor Code 6401.9 and Cal/OSHA Title 8 Section 3342 (healthcare workplace violence). Report every incident, including verbal threats, within the shift through the SafeCare reporting system.
- **Just Culture:** errors from system problems are treated as learning opportunities. Reckless behaviour is subject to discipline.
- **Safe patient handling:** lift equipment and lift teams are available on all inpatient units (CA Labor Code 6403.5).
- **Personal protective equipment (PPE):** provided at no cost. Fit-testing for N95 respirators is done annually.

7. Discipline and fair treatment

Corrective action steps are coaching, a documented verbal warning, a written warning, a final written warning and termination. Union-represented employees follow the relevant collective bargaining agreement (e.g. RN, SEIU service, and engineering units). Employees may use the Fair Treatment Process for any grievance.

8. Compliance and speaking up

- **Amerimed Integrity Line:** 1-888-555-0198 (24/7, anonymous) | integrity.amerimedwellness.example
- Non-retaliation is guaranteed under the False Claims Act (31 U.S.C. 3730(h)) and California Health & Safety Code 1278.5 (patient-safety whistleblowers).

9. Annual requirements

Annual Code of Conduct attestation, HIPAA privacy and security, fraud waste and abuse, infection prevention, fire and life safety, workplace violence prevention, and (for clinical staff) competency validation and BLS/ACLS/PALS as required.

Amerimed Wellness Institute is a fictional healthcare organisation created for AI training and demonstration. It does not provide medical care. All names, facilities, addresses and identifiers are invented. Nothing in this document is medical or legal advice.